

Mississippi

This state in the Deep South is named after the massive Mississippi River that snakes along its western border.

Head here to experience the blues style of music, which is wonderfully rich in feeling and history. Or ask a local for the Mississippi story about how the teddy bear got its name.



Teddy bears

During a hunting trip in Mississippi, former president Theodore "Teddy" Roosevelt, refused to kill a helpless, trapped bear. A toy maker was inspired to create a stuffed toy bear and call it "Teddy's Bear."

State Facts

Abbreviation: MS

Capital: Jackson

Nickname: The Magnolia State

Statehood: 1817, 20th state

Population: 3 million people

State animal: white-tailed deer

State bird: northern mockingbird

